

Before the Day of TV Shaving Commercials

PHILS' ANDY COHEN IS 'FIRED' AS ONE OF 2 BATTING 1.000

Special to the Dispatch
and New York Herald Tribune
PHILADELPHIA, April 16—If you're 40 or better and didn't squander your youth on such nonsense as school books and laboratory research, the resolution of the Phillies' home opener here Thursday night undoubtedly stirred you beyond words. Andy Cohen manager of the chronic cellar-dwellers for one game, opened and closed with a victory. He beat the powerful Braves, out-manuevering that master-mover, Chuck Dressen, as though it was something to be done every night in the week instead of once in a career of almost 40 years.

Back in the days when John McGraw thought he finally had box-office lure for Jewish customers in the chunky little Texas second baseman, Andy buddied it up with a gargantuan giant catcher named Shanty Hogan. Hogan weighed more than 250 and wasn't satisfied. He literally ate his way out of the big leagues, using such subterfuges as writing "spinach" on a dining-room chit and sitting back to await the conniving waiter with a double eclair.

There weren't TV shaving commercials in the late '20s but there was a demand for ball players who could sing a little and wouldn't blow a punch line. So Cohen and Hogan hooked up with a savings-and-snappy-patter vaudeville routine that did all right to the tune of \$1,800 a week, post-season. It was Cohen and Hogan all over the Keith circuit except in Boston where the names were reserved.

Thursday night the old trouper didn't forget his vaudeville lessons. After the 10-inning triumph, where he juggled left-handed, right-handed situations just like a Stengel, Andy Cohen gave the old Dixie finish and left the customers, 32,000 of them, smiling. They almost forgot in that brief moment of local glory, the only reason for Andy running the show alternately from the first-base coaching box and the bench. It was because Gene Mauch, replacement for Eddie Sawyer, wouldn't get here from Florida until today's game.

"Look at me," moaned Andy before the game, "all my life I wanted to manage in the majors, and now I'm hired and fired on the same night." That he was, except he goes out with a 1.000 record matched only by Brooklyn's Clyde Sukeforth.

Suke was projected into the managerial role for the first two games of the 1947 campaign Happy Chandler gave Leo Durocher the hook for the season and Branch Rickey had trouble locating Barney

Mauch Says Phillies 'Start From Scratch'

PHILADELPHIA, April 16, AP — "What happens from now on is what counts," says Gene Mauch, new manager of the Philadelphia Phillies. Thus he scoffs at pre-season predictions the team will finish last in the National League.

Sun-tanned and smiling, the 34-year-old Californian arrived yesterday and said he expected the Phillies to play winning baseball. He gets his first look as manager today when the Phillies play the Milwaukee Braves in the second of a three-game series.

Mauch was picked by General Manager John Quinn to replace Eddie Sawyer who quit with the season one day old.

Mauch, hired for two years, said he would have to watch the team before deciding if changes are needed.

"Everybody starts from scratch," he said. "Me, too. I want to see what the boys can do, not what someone tells me they can't.

"Every situation is different," he said. "Sometimes you have to show you're boss. Sometimes you keep quiet. A good player knows when he makes an error."

Mauch said that while managing the Minneapolis Millers in the American Association, as a major league infielder, he had seen most of the Phillies' players in action.

The Millers were last in club batting in 1958, when Mauch took over as manager. That year they won the Little World Series.

Mauch said the opportunity to manage the Phillies was not his first major league managerial offer.

"I wouldn't want to manage just any club, and actually this isn't the first chance I've had although I wouldn't like to name the team," he said.

"Why did I pick the Phillies?" he asked, anticipating the question. "Because I feel the Phillies are building."

Shotton scouting somewhere in the boondocks.

No other unbeaten managers come to mind and certainly, if McGraw didn't get his Jewish box office star for the Polo Ground back in the late 20s, he was instrumental in giving the Phillies their first, and presumably last, unbeaten manager.

Mauch is reportedly all enthusiasm over taking over a club which blew 90 decisions last year. He'll be the fifth Philly manager in nine years, a dubious arrangement of figures which dictate (A) home rentals only and (B) use of quick-service laundries only.

AMUSEMENTS